

LogiPulse — Phase 1 Roadmap & Retrospective

Smart Logistics Platform for NorthBeam Logistics — delivered Q4 2025

Codename	LogiPulse	Client	NorthBeam Logistics
Phase	Phase 1 (delivered) + Phase 2 (active)	Tier	A (Strategic)
Phase 1 timeline	2025-04-15 to 2025-12-08 (34 weeks)	Phase 2 timeline	2026-03-15 to 2026-09-30
Engagement value	Phase 1: \$185K USD; Phase 2 quoted: \$260K USD	Lead	Marcus Chen + Aarav Patel
Doc owner	Aarav Patel	Last updated	2026-04-12

1. Project Overview

NorthBeam Logistics is a Tier-1 North American freight scale-up (~1,800 employees, \$340M ARR as of 2025) operating cross-border B2B fulfillment between the US, Mexico, and Canada. They reached out to Prism in Q1 2025 after their internal warehouse-management tooling hit a usability ceiling: PDA scanners on the warehouse floor required 14 taps to complete a single inbound action, leading to a 11% scan-error rate and an estimated 22 minutes of friction per worker per shift.

LogiPulse is the codename for the redesigned platform: a unified PDA mobile experience for warehouse staff, plus a web admin console for shift supervisors and operations leads. The project was tiered as Tier-A from the start — multi-phase potential, public-grade brand, Marcus owns the relationship.

1.1 Original problem statement (from BRD intake, April 2025)

"Reduce average warehouse worker shift friction by 40% and scan-error rate to under 3%, while making the supervisor's daily exception triage workflow visual and proactive rather than reactive."

1.2 Engagement scope

- Mobile PDA application for warehouse floor (iOS-first, then Android)
- Web admin console for supervisors (Chrome-targeted desktop)
- A small data-dashboard component for ops directors (added in Phase 1.5)
- Design system extension (colour, type, components specifically for industrial UI)
- Engineering handoff support and design QA for the production rollout

2. Project Team

Role	Name	Allocation	Period
Engagement Lead / Client Owner	Marcus Chen	~10%	Throughout

Senior UX/Product Designer	Aarav Patel	80%	Throughout, project lead
Interaction Designer (Web admin)	Tomás Herrera	60%	Weeks 6-32
Junior Visual Designer (specs/handoff)	Mei Zhang	50%	Weeks 22-34
Junior UX (research support)	Noah Williams	30%	Weeks 1-12
Product Manager (data dashboard add-on)	Michael Brennan	40%	Weeks 26-34
Operations Manager / PM	Sophia Reyes	15%	Throughout
Design QA review (per milestone)	Priya Nair	10%	At reviews

3. Phase 1 Milestones (Delivered)

All seven Phase 1 milestones shipped on schedule except M5 (delayed 7 days, see retrospective).

Milestone	Description	Original date	Actual	Status
M1 Kickoff	Project kickoff, team introductions, BRD finalisation	2025-04-15	2025-04-15	On time
M2 Discovery complete	Onsite warehouse research, 14 worker shadowing sessions, 6 supervisor interviews	2025-05-23	2025-05-21	Early
M3 IA + flow	Information architecture, primary flows, low-fi wireframes for PDA + Web	2025-06-30	2025-06-30	On time
M4 Mid-fi review 1	First client review with mid-fi PDA prototype	2025-08-04	2025-08-05	On time
M5 Hi-fi PDA	Hi-fidelity PDA design, motion specs, design system v0.5	2025-09-15	2025-09-22	Delayed 7d (CASE-001)
M6 Hi-fi Web admin + dashboard	Web admin and ops dashboard hi-fi design	2025-10-27	2025-10-25	Early
M7 Engineering handoff + QA	Specs delivered, design QA across implementation	2025-12-08	2025-12-08	On time

4. Phase 1 Outcomes (Production Metrics, Q1 2026 Post-launch)

Measured 12 weeks after rollout to NorthBeam's flagship Memphis fulfillment centre. Source: NorthBeam internal ops dashboard, accessed via mutual NDA window.

Metric	Baseline (pre-LogiPulse)	Target (BRD)	Actual	Outcome
Avg PDA taps per inbound action	14	<= 6	5.2	Beat

Scan error rate	11%	<= 3%	2.1%	Beat
Avg shift friction (minutes)	22	<= 13	11.8	Beat
Supervisor exception triage time / day	47 min	<= 30 min	28 min	Beat
Worker satisfaction (CSAT)	3.1 / 5	>= 4.0	4.4	Beat
Engineering implementation fidelity	n/a	>= 90%	96%	Beat
Onboarding time for new warehouse hires	2.5 days	<= 1.5 days	0.9 days	Beat

4.1 Client testimonial

"Prism walked into our warehouses, watched our people work, and came back with a redesign that our floor staff stopped me in the aisle to thank me for. We've never had that. The Memphis center is now our most efficient site by 18%, and we're rolling out to four more this quarter." — Sarah Greenfield, VP Operations, NorthBeam Logistics

5. What Went Well, What We'd Do Differently

5.1 What worked

- **The four-day onsite at Memphis (M2)** was the single highest-ROI activity of the project. Aarav's industrial design background let him spot interactions our pure-software designers wouldn't have. Recommend keeping onsite research mandatory for Tier-A logistics work.
- **The 'tiered experience' resolution to CASE-001 (animation rejected by client tech team)** — we proposed a graceful degradation pattern that let new PDA hardware get the polished motion while older devices got a flat fallback. Client tech accepted the proposal in 48 hours and it became a reusable internal pattern.
- **Strong cross-team rhythm with the client's engineering manager.** Bi-weekly 30-min syncs from week 6 onward turned what could have been a fidelity battle into a partnership. Implementation fidelity 96% is largely down to this.
- **Phasing the data dashboard add-on (Phase 1.5)** let us absorb a meaningful scope expansion without delaying core PDA delivery. Michael Brennan owning the dashboard scope kept design from being pulled across two threads.

5.2 What we'd do differently

- **The 7-day delay at M5 (CASE-001 fallout)** is on us. Aarav had built the full motion design before validating with NorthBeam's tech team. We should have run a hardware-performance check at the mid-fi stage. The studio-wide takeaway: any motion-heavy industrial project must include a 'hardware compatibility check' before hi-fi work begins. Now part of the standard project template.
- **Underestimated the spec/handoff effort for industrial UI.** Mei Zhang's 50% allocation in weeks 22-34 turned out to be a real load — specs for state machines, error conditions, and fallback flows were ~2x what consumer projects need. Future industrial-UI quotes should reflect this.
- **Onboarding to the design system was rough.** NorthBeam's in-house design team (3 designers) didn't have a clean way to extend our component library after handoff. We've since built a 'system care package'

deliverable — recorded walkthroughs, a Figma library guide, a 30-day office-hours window post-handoff. Standard for Tier-A from 2026.

- **Research-to-design loop was slow in weeks 12-16.** Hannah Lindqvist wasn't on this project; Noah Williams handled research support. For Tier-A logistics work going forward, default to a researcher named in the contract.

6. Phase 2 Outlook

Phase 2 is contracted (signed 2026-02-26, satisfying OKR KR1.1) at \$260K USD. Scope: roll out to four additional fulfillment centres (Atlanta, Phoenix, Toronto, Mexico City), build out the supervisor mobile app (separate from the worker PDA), and ship a customisation layer for centre-specific workflows. The Phase 2 team is mostly continuous from Phase 1 with the addition of Hannah Lindqvist (User Researcher) for the localisation research thread — Mexico City and Toronto need linguistic and cultural adaptation work.

6.1 Phase 2 milestones (preview)

Milestone	Date	Lead
M1 Phase 2 kickoff	2026-03-15	Marcus Chen
M2 Localisation research (MX, CA)	2026-04-30	Hannah Lindqvist
M3 Supervisor app design	2026-06-15	Aarav Patel
M4 Customisation layer hi-fi	2026-07-30	Tomás Herrera
M5 Engineering handoff Phase 2	2026-09-30	Aarav Patel

7. Studio-wide Lessons

Patterns from LogiPulse that have already been incorporated into Prism's standard process:

- The 'tiered experience' pattern (motion fallback for hardware constraints) is now in the Pattern Library
- Hardware compatibility check at mid-fi stage is a mandatory phase-gate for industrial-UI work
- The 'system care package' (recorded walkthroughs + 30-day post-handoff support) is standard for Tier-A engagements as of Q1 2026
- Onsite research is mandatory for industrial / floor-operations clients; budget at least 4 days
- A named researcher in the contract is required for Tier-A engagements

— Document end. For questions about this engagement, contact Aarav Patel (project lead) or Marcus Chen (client owner). —